

Although Linux-based systems have several strong security protections built-in, one major potential vulnerability might exist when local access is given. File permission problems are caused by a user not giving the proper permissions to files and directories.

If you are using Linux (or even OS X) for a while, you have undoubtedly run across a “permissions” problem. But, what are they exactly? Why are they required or beneficial?

Basic File Permissions



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Linux file permission and working

Each file and directory has three permission groups dependent on the user:

- **Owner:** The Owner rights apply exclusively to the file or directory's owner; they do not affect other users' activities.
- **Group:** Group permissions only apply to the group that has been allocated to the files and folders; they have no impact on other users' activities.
- **All Users:** The All Users permissions apply to all the other users on the network; this is the permission group you should be most concerned with.